concussion, fractured ribs, and contusions to her face. The criminals called her "a bloody Jew," threw a burning stick at her, and hit her in the stomach. Men had threatened in the past "that they would slit her throat." Police were stationed outside her home to protect her.[7] It was subsequently reported that several Jewish families had removed their *mezuzah*s from their doorposts, in order to avoid being identified as Jews and becoming targets of violence. In view of the threats, about fifteen Jewish businesspeople hired security guards.[8]

In summer 2014, the Meldpunt Discriminatie Internet (MDI), which monitors discrimination on the Internet, revealed that it had never received so many complaints about antisemitism in its seventeen years of existence. Usually there are calls regarding such incidents two or three times a week. During part of the Protective Edge campaign, MDI received twenty to thirty complaints *per day*.[9]

Rabbi Binyomin Jacobs, the Dutch Chief Rabbi of the communities outside the three major cities, stated on a national TV program that an increasing number of Jewish families want to leave the Netherlands because they feel unsafe and are constantly being threatened or insulted on the streets. Jacobs added that he, too, had wondered whether it was safe for him to remain in the Netherlands, but concluded that he must stay, because a captain should be the last to leave a sinking ship.[10]

Never before in the four hundred years of Dutch independence has a leading Jewish figure made such a statement. The situation of Dutch Jews has now become a symbol of the increasing decay of the Netherlands. The Dutch attitude toward the Jews and toward Israel can provide observers with an ongoing prism on this degradation. At the same time, we should remember that the Netherlands are only one example among many of the antisemitism and Israel-hatred manifest across Europe.

SCOTLAND IN 2014

The 2014 Protective Edge campaign became a powerful illustration of how Jews and Israel are viewed in Europe. There has been a dramatic increase in antisemitic incidents in the European Union since the beginning of the twenty-first century. During the violent Gaza conflict the number of antisemitic incidents reached new heights. This increase in antismitism has exposed what we might call Ugly Europe (UE). Synagogues were vandalized, Jews were physically and verbally attacked. There were calls to kill Jews and demonstrations took place which were reminiscent of the 1930s.

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